ER OUT-OF-NETWORK REVENUE CYCLE · LEADERSHIP BRIEFING · OCTOBER 2026

ER OON Operating Model 2027

We meet the January 1 Gateway deadline with Model C. Lebanon prepares every dispute in the IDR Prep Studio; a five-person US desk copies it into the Gateway and submits. Every account gets one owner from coding to payment, and people grow by skill.

- Hard deadline: the IDR Gateway becomes US-only on January 1, 2027

5	10	L0–L5	12 → 31	$328–400K
US desk staff with Model C, about 15 minutes per dispute	full-cycle teams replace 12 facility teams	six levels; 15 skill badges in three families drive level and routing	facilities absorbed in two years without new teams	saved a year by year two with Model C, against Model A

WHY NOW

Three pressures arrive together

Each one alone would justify change. Together they make the current facility-based structure untenable.

Jan 1

The Gateway goes US-only

Our negotiators spend 50–70% of their time in it today. From January 1, only US-based staff may use it.

5×

Workload is uneven

Open claims per person range from 138 to 704 across facility teams. Effort, not geography, should set the load.

+19

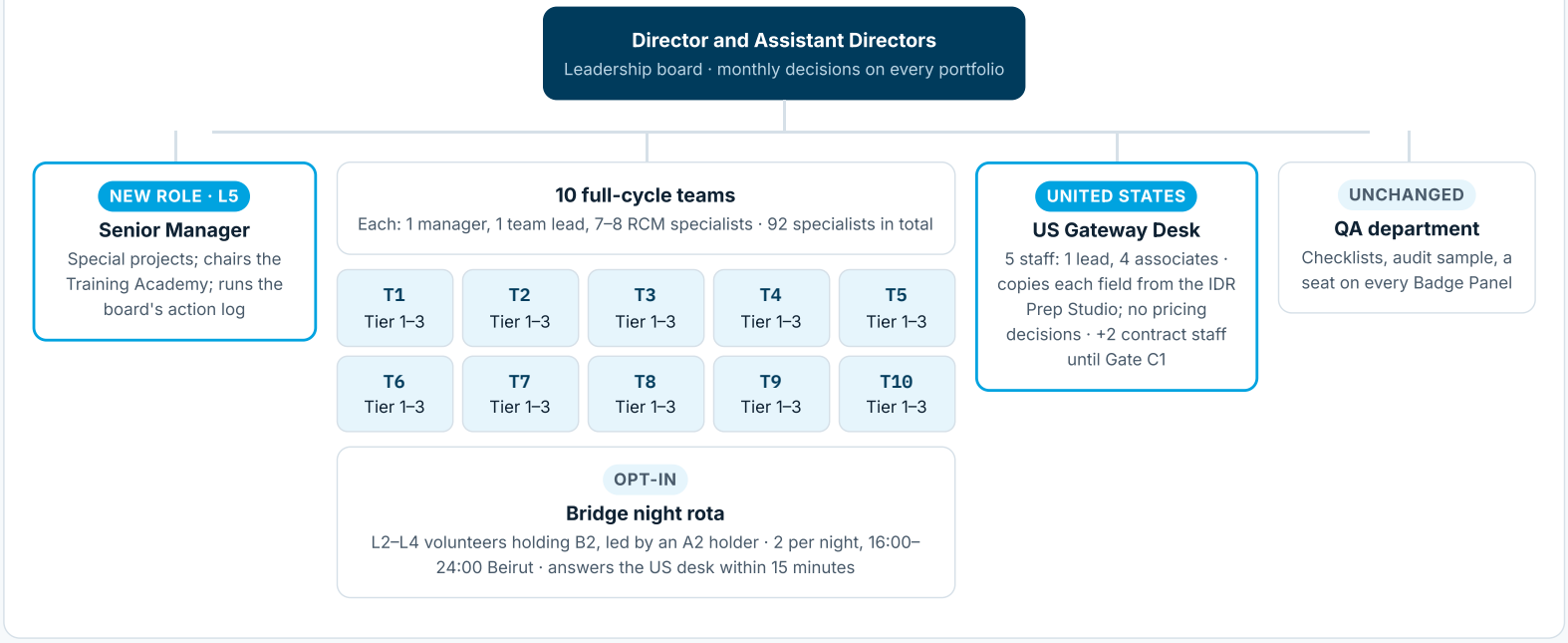
We are growing fast

We go from 12 to 31 facilities in two years. The model must absorb them without adding a team for each one.

THE STRUCTURE

One owner per account, ten balanced teams, a US desk for the Gateway

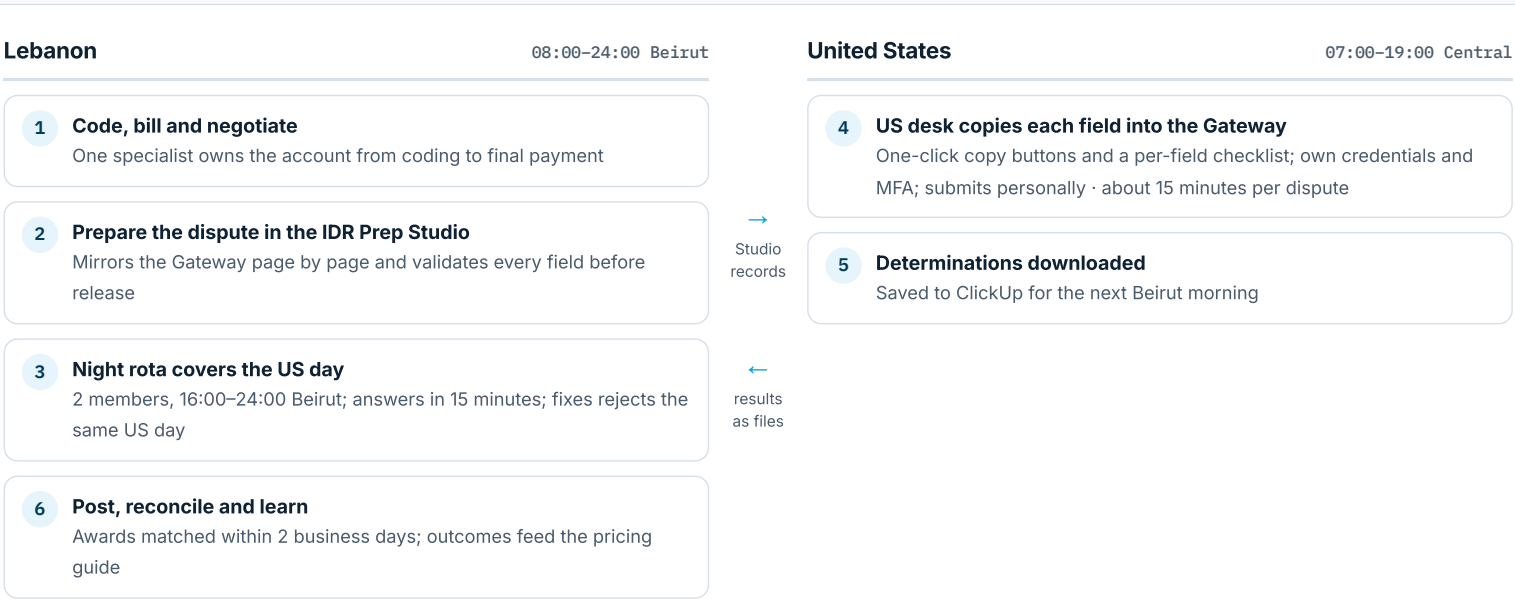
Teams own payer portfolios, not facilities. Lebanon prepares every dispute and keeps every pricing decision; the US desk only copies the prepared work into the Gateway.



HOW WORK MOVES

Lebanon prepares in the Studio, the US copies and files, results return overnight

Only prepared work crosses the boundary. No one outside the US ever sees or operates a Gateway session, and no tool touches the Gateway.



GUARDRAIL Manual entry by a US person only. No shared logins, screen sharing, remote control or form filling in the Gateway. Legal signs off on the onshore rule before go-live.

BRIDGE NIGHT ROTA

Volunteers cover the US day, paid from a fixed quarterly pool

The night rota replaces the two team leads on the old bridge shift. Any L2, L3 or L4 holding B2 (IDR Process Workflow) can opt in; each night's lead holds A2 (IDR Strategy). It reports to the Onshore–Offshore Liaison portfolio owner.

16:00–24:00
Beirut, Monday to Friday (08:00–16:00 Central)

2
members a night, at least one A2 holder as night lead

130
member-nights a quarter

Duties
Check tickets due that day, answer the US desk within 15 minutes, fix rejected tickets the same US day, post the nightly handover log.

Full share when
98% first-pass tickets, US desk answered within 15 minutes, no deadline missed because of a ticket, and all assigned nights worked. Swaps allowed; missed nights reduce the share pro rata.

Rota set each quarter from the opt-ins: 10 members at 1 night a week, up to 20 at 1 night every other week, or any size in between. Transport home after the shift as before.

$30,000 a quarter, shared equally

ROTA MEMBERS	SHARE PER MEMBER, PER QUARTER
10	$3,000
15	$2,000
20	$1,500
30	$1,000
50	$600
100	$300

About $230 per night worked at any rota size. The $300 floor caps the rota at 100. Up to $120,000 a year.

THREE WAYS TO RUN THE US DESK

Model C is ready for January 1 and keeps most of the saving

All three share the ten full-cycle teams, levels and badges. They differ only in how Gateway filing is done. Recruiting is in-house, so no recruiting fees are included.

Model A · People-first

SAFEST, COSTLIEST

7	~47 min	$346–421K
US desk staff	per dispute	US desk a year today

- US desk types from ClickUp tickets
- Ready on January 1 · legal sign-off on the onshore rule only
- Absorbs absences well · 1 of 7 people
- Cost grows with volume · $861K–1.05M by year two

Model B · Automation-first

BIGGEST SAVING, MOST RISK

3	~10 min	$192–244K
US desk staff	target per dispute	US desk and AI a year today

- A Submission Cockpit fills the Gateway · operator checks and submits
- Needs written Gateway confirmation that assisted filling is allowed
- Not ready on January 1 · runs on A's desk until Gate 2, April 30
- Fragile to absence · 1 of 3 people

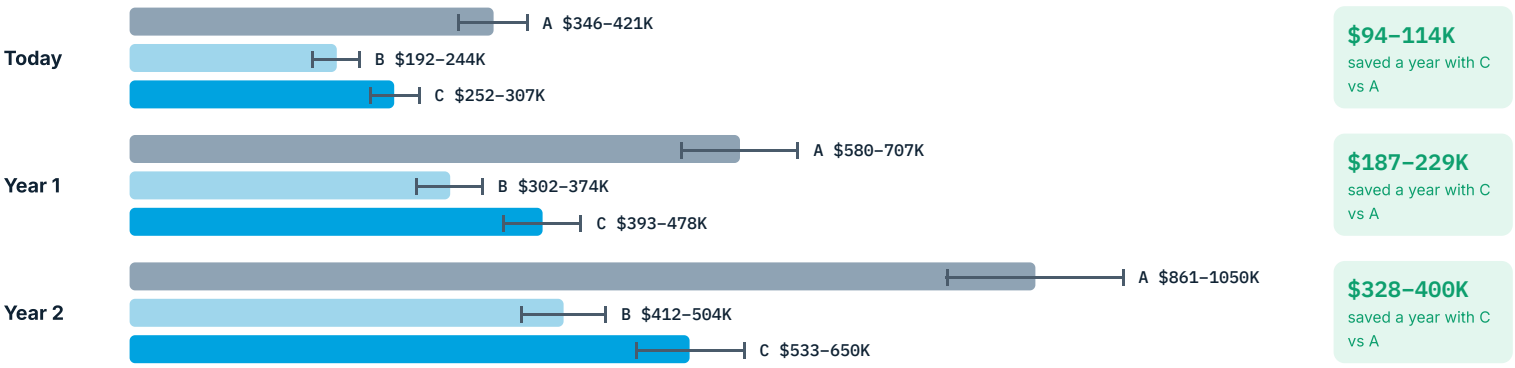
Model C · Guided copy desk

PROPOSED · MIDDLE GROUND

5	~15 min	$252–307K
US desk staff	target per dispute	US desk a year today

- Lebanon prepares in the IDR Prep Studio · validates every field
- US desk copies each field and submits personally · no tool touches the Gateway
- Ready on January 1 · Studio built, tested, used in the December parallel run
- Absorbs absences · 1 of 5 people; two shifts, 07:00–19:00 Central

Annual US desk cost: Models A, B and C



$94–114K saved a year with C vs A

$187–229K saved a year with C vs A

$328–400K saved a year with C vs A

QUESTION	MODEL A	MODEL B	MODEL C	EDGE
Ready for January 1?	Yes	No; runs on A's desk until Gate 2, April 30	Yes; Studio built and tested	A, C
Outside approvals needed	Legal sign-off on the onshore rule	Also written Gateway confirmation of assisted filling	Onshore rule only (manual entry by a US person)	A, C
Time per dispute	About 47 minutes	Target 10 minutes	Target 15 minutes	B
Resilience to absence	1 of 7 people	1 of 3 people	1 of 5 people	A
Lebanon specialists by year two	About 125	About 102, with AI drafting	About 125; can add AI drafting later	B
Cost by year two	$861K–1.05M	$412–504K	$533–650K	B
Main risk	Cost grows with volume	Gateway terms; a 3-person desk	Copy errors, checked by Studio validation, a per-field checklist and bridge review	C

Recommendation: propose Model C. It is ready for January 1 with tools we already have, needs no Gateway approval beyond the onshore rule, keeps a 5-person desk that absorbs absences, and saves $94–114K a year today and $328–400K by year two against Model A. That is about 60–75% of Model B's saving with far less risk.

PEOPLE AND CAREERS

One role, six levels, earned by skill

Former titles no longer set pay or work. Fifteen badges in three families show what each specialist can do alone, control what ClickUp routes to them, and open the next level. L1 and L2 follow automatically from badges; L3, L4 and L5 need a leveling test.

L0
Junior RCM Specialist
Newly recruited · no badges yet

L1
RCM Specialist I
All 5 C badges · automatic

L2
RCM Specialist II
5 C + B1 or B2 + 2 of B3, B4, B5 · automatic

L3
Senior Specialist I
5 C + all 5 B + 1 A · L3 leveling test · Tier 1

L4
Senior Specialist II
5 C + all 5 B + 3 A · L4 leveling test · Tier 1 · specialty-group lead

L5
Principal · Leadership
5 C + all 5 B + 4 A · L5 leveling test · a team lead or manager post

The 15 badges

C · Core All five for L1	**C1** Attaching Docs	**C2** Claim Follow-up	**C3** Appeal	**C4** Payment Posting	**C5** Medical-Necessity Report
B · Specialist Three for L2, all five for L3	**B1** Coding	**B2** IDR Process Workflow	**B3** MVA and WComp Negotiation & Process	**B4** Payer Strategy	**B5** Payer Outreach
A · Advanced 1 for L3, 3 for L4, 4 for L5	**A1** Reporting and Analysis	**A2** IDR Strategy	**A3** Medical Terminology	**A4** Billing Strategy	**A5** Innovation

Each badge: Academy module, supervised production, then an assessment in a quarterly test window. Classroom time: C family 38 h, B family 64 h, A family 62 h.

Leadership (L5): L5 badge set + leveling test with a coaching assessment + a team lead post → **Team Lead**

L5 badge set + leveling test with a leadership assessment + a manager post → **Manager** Senior Manager is also L5.

How you move up

L1 · L2
Automatic
At the next quarterly window after the badges are held. No minimum time in level.

L3 · L4 · L5
Leveling test
Case-based exam plus a 6-month review: QA 95%+ (L3) or 97%+ (L4, L5), zero missed deadlines.

Top 10%
Annual ranking
Each December, within each level. The top 10% earn the missing badges of their level; an L2 moves up to L3 without the test.

Every move up
A pay raise
Every move up a level comes with a pay raise, including the move to Team Lead or Manager.

Keep your badges

Quarterly
Test windows
Last two weeks of March, June, September and December. Experienced staff can test out without the course.

Jun 30 · Dec 31
Semiannual KPI review
QA by badge, critical errors, work units and Net Recovery for the half-year.

Lose 25%
Probation and coaching
90 days: written plan, full review of the affected work, re-test in the next window.

Lose 50%
Termination
Through the HR process, with documented reviews and one appeal.

LEVEL	BADGES HELD	PROBATION AT	TERMINATION AT
L1	5	2 lost	3 lost
L2	8	2 lost	4 lost
L3	11	3 lost	6 lost
L4	13	4 lost	7 lost
L5	14	4 lost	7 lost

Counted against badges held at the start of the half-year, rounded up. The June 2027 review is coaching only; consequences start with the December 2027 review. Subject to HR and legal review under Lebanese labor law before publication.

TRANSITION · JANUARY–MARCH 2027

Everyone starts at a default level and confirms it with tests

In December 2026 every member is ranked within their current role on 2026 KPIs. The ranking decides who is confirmed automatically, who tests, and who starts in the Academy. Levels take effect on April 1, 2027.

Top 10%

Badges earned automatically

No tests. Confirmed at their default level with the badges of their current role.

- Negotiator: C2, C5, B2, B5, A2
- Coder: C1, C5, B1, A3
- Biller: C1, C2, C3, C4, B5; B3 for MVA or workers' comp
- Senior: the role badges of their specialty

Middle 80%

Three months to pass the role's badge tests

Optional full skill assessment in January shows needs and current level. Tests in the February or March windows, January 4 to March 31.

PASS — Confirmed at the default level

PASS NEXT LEVEL — Move up one level, for example a Biller to L3

FAIL — Move down one level (L3 → L2, L2 → L1)

Bottom 10%

L1 and the Academy

Enrolled in the Academy and placed at L1. They return to L2 automatically once they hold the L2 badges.

Default level by current role

Seniors	L3 Senior Specialist I
Negotiators, Coders, Billers	L2 RCM Specialist II
Team Leads	Keep their post at L5
Managers	Keep their post at L5

Missing badges for the confirmed level are earned through cross-training by December 31, 2027; the level is held provisionally until then. Team leads and managers have until the same date to complete the L5 badge set, with Academy support.

Pay during the transition

No pay cuts
No one's pay goes down, including anyone moved down a level.

Every move up
Comes with a pay raise, from April 1, 2027.

Annual merit reviews follow the company's existing policy.

Dec 2026 — Rank
Top and bottom 10% published

Jan 2027 — Skill assessment
Optional; shows needs and level

Feb–Mar 2027 — Test windows
Role badges: core, specialist and advanced

Apr 1, 2027 — Levels take effect
Raises paid on upgrades

Dec 31, 2027 — Full badge sets
Missing badges earned by cross-training

OUR COMMITMENT

No one loses their job or pay because of the restructure. From December 2027 everyone is held to the same badge and performance standards.

TRAINING ACADEMY

A new hire holds all five core badges in six months

Training happens on live work: about 20% classroom, 80% supervised production checked by a badge-holder. A committee awards badges and recommends promotions; no one decides alone on their own team. Each Badge Panel is a QA reviewer plus 2 assessors (L4s or Team Leads) from other teams.

The Academy Committee

1	**Chair and owner**	A manager, preferably the Senior Manager
2–3	**Managers**	From different teams; 12-month staggered terms
2+2	**L4 Senior Specialists II and L3 Senior Specialists I**	Lead trainers and assessors; teaching counts toward L4
2	**Team leads, rotating**	New pair each quarter; 8 serve every year
1	**QA reviewer**	Scores quality; sits on every Badge Panel

From day one to L2

Weeks 1–2	Months 1–2	Months 3–4
L0 onboarding	**C1 + C4**	**C2 + C5**
HIPAA, systems, NSA	Attaching docs, posting	Follow-up, medical necessity
Months 5–6	Next window	6–12 months later
C3	**L1, automatic**	**L2, automatic**
Appeal	All five core badges	B1 or B2 + 2 of B3, B4, B5

Dec 2027	**2+**	**4×**
full badge set for every confirmed level	holders of every badge in every team	test windows a year, every badge offered

LEADERSHIP PORTFOLIOS

Every manager owns one area the model depends on

Eleven portfolios, one per manager and the Senior Manager. Owners are assigned by the leadership board. Dashed tiles are additions the model needs to succeed.

Training Academy
Onboard, train, test, award, promote
Every level's badge set held by Dec 31, 2027

Payments and Reconciliation
Every dollar posted and reconciled
IDR awards matched in 2 business days

Onshore–Offshore Liaison
Lebanon, US desk, night rota, accounting
98% same-day completion

External Relations
IDR entities and payers
80% of escalations resolved in 30 days

Automation, ClickUp, AI and Data
Tools, the Studio, one source of numbers
Dashboards ready by the 3rd business day

Coding Quality
Guidelines and E/M level ratios
95% coding audit accuracy

Denials and NNSA Strategy
Patterns, appeals, letter library
Denial rate down every quarter

IDR Performance
Results by location, payer, entity
Win rate and recovery after fees

Compliance and Deadlines
Deadlines, HIPAA, Gateway access
Zero missed regulatory deadlines

Pricing Guide
Offers, settlements, decision rights
100% inside the guide or approved

Capacity and Growth
Workload balance, 19 new facilities
Teams within 90–110% of target

How they report
Findings and recommendations, every month
One template, one set of numbers

Monthly report
To the director and assistant directors by the 5th business day

Monthly leadership board
Each owner presents findings; the board decides

Quarterly deep-dive
Every portfolio reviewed in depth once a quarter

Yearly review
Targets reset; owners confirmed or rotated

ROADMAP

The Gateway first, then the teams, then the levels

The cutover happens on December 19, two weeks before the deadline. Team structure changes only after the Gateway is stable, and levels take effect after the transition tests.

Oct 2026	Nov 2026	Dec 2026	Jan–Mar 2027	Apr–Jun 2027	Jul 2027–2028
Prepare	**Build and train**	**Parallel run**	**Launch and transition**	**Levels live**	**Full cycle and growth**
Legal sign-off; hire 5 + 2 contract US staff	Studio tested; ticket workflow live by Nov 21	All Gateway work through the Studio; KPI ranking	10 teams live; skill assessment; badge tests	Levels from April 1; cross-training on the badge sets	Full badge sets by Dec 31, 2027; 19 facilities join existing teams

Dec 19	Jan 1, 2027	Mar 15	Apr 1	Jun 30	Dec 31, 2027
Full cutover	**Gateway US-only**	**Gate C1**	**Levels take effect**	**First KPI review**	**Badge sets due**
Same-day completion; 98% first-pass tickets	Hard regulatory deadline	≤15 min per dispute, errors under 0.5%, no missed deadline for 4 weeks → desk steps down to 5	Raises paid on upgrades; no pay cuts	Coaching only; no badge loss	First badge-loss review; same standards for everyone from here

If Gate C1 is missed, or the backlog stays above one business day for 5 days, or the desk causes a missed deadline, we extend the contracts or add staff, back toward Model A. Model B's Cockpit stays a later option once the Gateway confirms assisted filling is allowed.

RISKS WE ARE MANAGING

Every major risk has an owner and a fallback

We misread the Gateway's onshore rule — HIGH IMPACT

Legal sign-off before the build; offshore access stays as a fallback until December 19.

Copy errors at the US desk — MODEL C

Studio validates every field; per-field checklist; night rota review. Gate C1 requires errors under 0.5%.

The US desk falls behind as volume grows — MEDIUM

Contract staff stay until Gate C1; a backlog trigger extends them or adds staff.

People read new levels as a demotion — MEDIUM

Default levels, no pay cuts, a pay raise on every move up, published criteria and one appeal.

We lose IDR experts during the change — HIGH IMPACT

Early, open communication and a Senior Specialist path that doesn't require managing.

DECISIONS REQUESTED TODAY

Seven approvals to start in October

1. **Approve Model C for the US Gateway Desk**
   5 permanent staff (1 lead, 4 associates) plus 2 contract staff until Gate C1, hired in-house from October
2. **Approve the 10 full-cycle teams**
   Launch in January–February 2027, after the Gateway cutover
3. **Approve levels L0–L5 and the 15 badges**
   Automatic L1 and L2, leveling tests for L3–L5
4. **Approve the testing and badge-loss policy**
   Quarterly tests, semiannual review; subject to HR and legal review
5. **Approve the transition plan**
   Ranking in December, tests January–March, levels effective April 1, 2027
6. **Approve the bridge night rota**
   Opt-in L2–L4 holding B2, A2 night lead; a $30,000 bonus pool each quarter
7. **Create the Senior Manager role and the portfolios**
   Senior Manager (L5) in place before the Academy set-up

Sources: ER OON Operating Model 2027 executive summary; Models A, B and C comparison; RCM Specialist Badge Competency Matrix; Training Academy curriculum; Manager portfolios appendix. US cost figures are approximate Texas market rates for direct hires, plus about 25% benefits and payroll taxes, not quotes. Recruiting is in-house and infrastructure is already in place, so neither is included.